



THE SAUNA
The sauna, or steam bath, was invented in Finland about 1,000 years ago as a way of cleaning and relaxing the body. After a hot sauna, many Finns cool off by plunging into an icy pool (below) or a snowdrift.



INDUSTRIAL STRENGTH
Manufacturing is an important source of employment and wealth throughout Scandinavia and Finland. Many of the goods produced here, such as machinery, medical and technological equipment, motor vehicles (Sweden), and pharmaceuticals (Denmark), are exported all over the world. In Denmark, many people also work in agriculture, fish processing, and brewing.

NORWEGIAN FIORDS
The west coast of Norway has thousands of deep inlets, known as fiords, gouged out of the mountains by glaciers during the last ice age and then flooded by the sea. The fiords run inland between high mountains and make a favorite destination for cruise ships bringing tourists to admire the stunning scenery.

BUILDING WITH WOOD
Much of Norway and Sweden, and two-thirds of Finland, is covered by dense forests of birch, pine, spruce, and other trees. Finland has more than 16 times more forested land per person than the European average. Many people in the region work in the forestry industry, producing wood for the construction and furniture industries. This great natural resource is also used to build homes and churches, like this medieval stave church (left) in Norway.



SAVING THE ENVIRONMENT
The people of all four countries are very environmentally conscious and recycle as many household items as they can. Strict national laws protect the environment from industrial waste and pollution, although there is growing concern about the levels of pollution in the Baltic Sea.